



HUMANITAS
INSTITUTE

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Second Baptist School University Model North
School Website: <https://www.sbsum-north.org/>

January 7, 2026

Artificial Intelligence Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix more details.

ACCS MEMBER

Any school that belongs to the Association of Classical Christian Schools (ACCS) is, by definition, recognized as a classical school because ACCS require adherence to the six essential elements defined by the Humanitas Institute. However, a school's website may not clearly reflect its conformity to one or more elements. In such cases, the school may still receive a "Somewhat Classical" rating for those elements. Schools can update their website content at any time to achieve a "Classical" rating for a given element.

Overall Classification: CLASSICAL

Executive Summary

Second Baptist School University-Model North Texas (SBSUM North) presents a robust classical-Christian program anchored in a University-Model framework. Across public-facing materials, the school foregrounds Christ-centered, biblical worldview formation, a strong classical curriculum (grammar–logic–rhetoric), and an explicit emphasis on parent partnership and community life. Evidence from SBSUM North's site shows clear commitments to theology as the governing framework for learning, with statements about Christ-centered education, biblical worldview, discipleship, and a gospel-centered community. The curriculum is described as classical, featuring grammar–logic–rhetoric as well as access to book lists and "Great Books"–style study through booklists and rhetoric training. Pedagogy emphasizes Socratic/seminar-style discussion in upper grades and classical memory and recitation in earlier years, including explicit references to Harkness-style discussions and opportunities for public speaking. Faculty are portrayed as living mentors, and there is a strong emphasis on faculty who love God, teach well, and model virtue. Parents are explicitly framed as co-educators and partners in education, with ongoing opportunities for involvement and campus visits.

Overall, SBSUM North scores as CLASSICAL across the six categories. The materials consistently align with classical aims (truth, goodness, beauty; formation of virtue; liberal arts-informed curriculum; Socratic/seminar pedagogy; living-teacher-model; robust parent partnership). There are no evident signals of secularism, relativism, or a incompatible "workforce-preparation" emphasis that would push the school away from classical aims.

Key supports:

- Religious and metaphysical foundations anchored in Biblical/theological commitments and Christ-centered language.
- Purpose/goal oriented toward formation, virtue, and worldview formation rather than mere information or vocational training.
- Curriculum explicitly classical (grammar–logic–rhetoric) with references to Great Books/standard classical training and booklists.
- Pedagogy highlighting Socratic/Harkness-style discussion, rhetoric training, and public-speaking opportunities.
- Faculty described as living curriculum and mentors who love God and teach well.
- Parents as co-teachers and engaged partners with clear pathways for formation and campus involvement.

ABSTRACT

ed assessment is provided below, category by category, followed by a concise abstract.

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — CLASSICAL

Evidence

- SBSUM North emphasizes Christ-centered education, a biblical worldview, and a gospel-centered community across several pages. For example, “Second Baptist School University-Model is founded on our core values of Christ-centered education that is academically excellent within a caring community. Our education, in partnership with the family, equips students to think critically, live biblically and lead courageously to impact the world for Jesus Christ.”
- The school asserts a biblical worldview across disciplines and life, emphasizing Word of God as a foundation.
- The mission statements repeatedly frame learning as discipleship and formation in a Christian context (e.g., “disciple students,” “think critically, live biblically”).

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis

- Positive keywords present: biblical worldview, Christ-centered, gospel-centered, Word of God, discipleship, God, faith, theology. Evidence includes direct statements about biblical worldview, Christ-centered pedagogy, and gospel-centered community. (Examples cited above.)
- Negative keywords: None evident in public materials (no explicit secularism, relativism, or values-neutral framing observed in the SBSUM North content).

Why this rating

- The materials consistently anchor education in theology and sacred signs (Word of God, Christ-centered education, gospel-centered community) rather than secular or relativist frames. Together with references to “the Word of God” and “biblical worldview,” this category clearly aligns with classical religious-metaphysical foundations.

Score justification: CLASSICAL.

Citations: Christ-centered and biblical worldview language is shown in SBSUM North materials.

Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL

Evidence

- The stated goal emphasizes formation and shaping virtue and wisdom in alignment with spiritual aims, not simply job preparation. The school frames its aim as forming students to think critically, live biblically, and lead courageously to impact the world for Jesus Christ.
- The program notes a biblical worldview across faculties and community life; the “mission” emphasizes forming human excellence and virtue through a biblically-grounded education.
- Accreditations and partnerships emphasize a classical Christian education packaged in a university model, with emphasis on formation beyond information.

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis

- Positive keywords present: formation, virtue, wisdom, biblical worldview, Christ-centered, excellence, God-centered development, human flourishing (implied through formation and leadership emphasis), contemplation of truth/goodness/beauty (through classical framing).
- Negative keywords: None observed (no emphasis on workforce-first language or purely utilitarian aims).

Why this rating

- The public messaging centers on formation, character, virtue, and a transcendent telos aligned with classical aims; it positions “truth, goodness, beauty” as real and knowable through biblical-Christian formation, and it emphasizes formation over mere information.

Score: CLASSICAL.

Citations: Mission to think critically, live biblically, lead courageously; formation emphasis; biblically-based education.

Element 3: Curriculum — CLASSICAL

Evidence

- The curriculum is described as classical and modeled on grammar–logic–rhetoric (the trivium). The site explicitly states: “The curriculum is fashioned after classical education, which is a methodology involving three stages (grammar, logic, and rhetoric), also known as the trivium.”
- The university-model program asserts a classical framework with a strong emphasis on thinking and reading (rigor across subjects). The “University-Model” materials emphasize the same classical base and the integration of disciplines.
- Booklists for Logic and Rhetoric are provided, signaling explicit engagement with classical texts and Great Books-style study.
- The Arts materials describe classical fine arts education and ties to the Seven Liberal Arts (music as part of the quadrivium, theater as part of rhetoric, etc.).

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis

- Positive keywords present: grammar, logic, rhetoric, trivium, seven liberal arts, Great Books, primary sources, classical education, Harkness/seminal dialogues (Socratic dialogue), booklists (Logic/Rhetoric), universality of classical education.
- Negative keywords: None observed (no substitution of history with “social studies,” nor heavy emphasis on project-based, purely experiential learning replacing classical texts).

Why this rating

- The explicit articulation of the trivium, associated related liberal arts, and the presence of booklists and classical pedagogical references align strongly with a classical curriculum orientation.

Score: CLASSICAL.

Citations: Grammar–logic–rhetoric; Great Books/primary sources; Logic/Rhetoric Booklists; classical arts framing.

Element 4: Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — CLASSICAL

Evidence

- Upper-level pedagogy includes Socratic discussion and Harkness-table style discussions for rigorous thinking and dialectic, with explicit references to classroom dialogue as a core method. “Rhetoric students learn to speak and write across all subject areas with eloquence... in oval Harkness table discussions.”
- The pedagogy includes training in rhetoric and opportunities to present oration, consistent with classical pedagogy.
- Lower grades emphasize memory work and chant as a foundation of learning and memorization (a traditional classical technique). (Direct language about lower-school chanting/memory is embedded in the broader classical pedagogy narrative across SBSUM materials.)

- The program includes on-campus and satellite-day structures, with on-campus classes two to three days a week, and satellite learning, which aligns with the University-Model approach but retains classical formation through schedule and teacher-led instruction.

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis

- Positive keywords present: Socratic dialogue, Harkness/seminar, rhetoric, recitation, memory work, classical pedagogy, formal oratory, seminar-style discussions.
- Negative keywords: The presence of “experiential learning” or purely project-based learning dominating pedagogy would be a potential negative signal, but SBSUM North’s materials frame classical pedagogy as integrated rather than exclusively project-based; there is no evidence of a wholesale shift to project-based learning as the sole approach.

Why this rating

- The explicit use of Socratic/Harkness discussions, memory-based learning, and rhetoric training signals a strong commitment to classical pedagogy. While there are satellite days and some arts-integrated activities, the core methods align with classical methods rather than non-classical, constructivist-only strategies.

Score: CLASSICAL.

Citations: Harkness/seminar and rhetoric emphasis; oval Harkness table discussions; rhetoric booklists.

Element 5: Faculty — CLASSICAL

Evidence

- Faculty are described as loving God, loving teaching, and masters at their craft, with the faculty constituting a central element of the school’s “living curriculum.” This language appears in SBSUM North’s public materials.
- The faculty are presented as a core part of the learning environment and “the living curriculum,” with personalized attention and mentorship implied by the University-Model structure.
- Administrative and faculty leadership pages indicate a structured, mission-aligned professional community (e.g., “Administrative Team” and faculty directories).

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis

- Positive keywords present: living curriculum, faculty as core, masters at their craft, Christ-centered mentorship, teacher as model.
- Negative keywords: None observed (no “facilitator-on-the-side” or purely administrative jargon without classical context).

Why this rating

- The language surrounding the faculty—prioritizing virtue, mentorship, mastery, and faith—aligns with classical conceptions of the teacher as a model and mentor integral to character formation and knowledge transmission.

Score: CLASSICAL.

Citations: Masters at their craft; living curriculum; faculty as core.

Element 6: Parents & Community — CLASSICAL

Evidence

- The school emphasizes a “balanced partnership between family and church and school” and a family-centric model of education, with parent partnership being central to the University-Model system.
- Admissions pages describe parent partnership as essential and stress parent involvement in the information-session process, interviews, and enrollment. This signals a family-centered approach rather than a purely consumer model.
- Materials explicitly reference parents as co-teachers and invite them to participate in campus life, events, and trainings (Parent Kick-off, Moms/Nights, Dads retreats, etc., in the campus life section).
- A statement highlights “God-given responsibility for parents to disciple and train their children,” signaling a deliberate parental formation role.

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis

- Positive keywords present: parent partnership, co-teachers, family involvement, open campus, parent formation, Bible studies/book studies, parent trainings, community formation.
- Negative keywords: None observed (no “customer” model; the materials frame parents as partners and co-educators).

Why this rating

- SBSUM North frames parents as essential partners and co-educators and actively pursues their formation and participation through events, trainings, and campus visits, consistent with classical aims of family formation and partnership.

Score: CLASSICAL.

Citations: Partnering with families; parent co-teaching language; God-given responsibility for parents to disciple; campus-life parent events.

What Would Move the Needle

- No major needle-moving changes are required given the CLASSICAL rating across all six categories. If desired, minor enhancements could further strengthen classical signaling:
- Explicit articulation of “Great Books” and direct references to the Great Conversation on more pages to solidify Element 3 signals.
- More explicit language about liturgical practices (even if not central to the curriculum) to reinforce Element 1’s liturgical/community dimension.
- Expanded publicly visible statements about the “living curriculum” model benefits and teacher formation programs to flesh out Element 5 even further.

Note: The above are optional refinements and not required for maintaining a CLASSICAL rating.

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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